

Julien Crésus-Ashton

SENIOR INTERACTION DESIGNER

Interaction designer with eight years in UK government and consumer apps. At HMRC I designed the Welsh and English Council Tax review service as a coded GOV.UK prototype, tested over six to seven research rounds with at least half Welsh-speaking participants. SC cleared.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant Nov 2023 – Present

Senior Interaction Designer

- Led interaction design for HMRC's Welsh Council Tax service during alpha, in Welsh and English, across six to seven research rounds with at least half Welsh-speaking participants. Mapped complex policy logic into navigable flows for all 22 Welsh local authorities.
- Designed Natural England's protected sites monitoring service, testing with ecologists and field surveyors. Testing showed users losing their bearings, so I added a site overview page, now part of the core service.
- Designed a DEFRA/APHA workforce planning tool on PowerBI, replacing team spreadsheets with one view of activities and absences for APHA managers. Designed within Fluent and PowerBI constraints, working with developers through to handoff.
- Set the standard for personas, interaction models and WCAG 2.2 across the team, and coached other designers on GDS and coded prototyping.

DAM Digital Apr 2022 – Nov 2023

Senior UX/UI Designer

- Led UX on Shy Lifestyle (a luxury concierge app, live at shy lifestyle.com), Rethink Mental Illness's donation module and McArthurGlen's shopping app, across up to 3 concurrent clients.
- Ran regular design reviews with clients and turned stakeholder feedback into design decisions grounded in user needs.
- Owned accessibility and design system standards across all concurrent projects, keeping them consistent.
- Coached a user researcher to independently produce production-ready Figma prototypes, upskilling their design craft and improving team throughput.

Methods Feb 2019 – Apr 2022

UX Designer

- Designed for government programmes including Every Mind Matters, National Funding Formula and Ministry of Defence, working to GDS standards across discovery, alpha and beta.
- Led cross-functional workshops with research, product and engineering, setting the design direction and ensuring decisions were grounded in user evidence before moving to build.
- Built research-informed prototypes in Figma and coded prototypes using React and the GOV.UK Design System, enabling faster collaboration with researchers and stakeholders than static tools allowed.

Société Générale Design Sep 2017 – Dec 2018

UX/UI Designer Trainee

- Designed interaction models for trading platforms and internal financial tools in low- and high-fidelity using Adobe XD and Sketch, shipping interface updates to internal trading systems used daily by the trading floor.
- Led co-creation sessions with traders, product owners and engineers to validate concepts early and reduce costly rework downstream.

SKILLS

- GDS Design System
- WCAG 2.2 accessibility
- Coded prototyping (React, GOV.UK Prototype Kit)
- Conditional routing and policy logic
- Bilingual Welsh and English services
- Service and journey mapping
- Workshop and design critique facilitation
- AI tools (Claude, Copilot)
- Figma, Sketch, Miro, Mural

EDUCATION

- MSc UX Design**
Kingston University, London
2018 · Thesis: WebVR app for autism awareness, exploring immersive environments as a medium for inclusive design and empathy-building.
- BA Web Design**
Epitech Digital, Paris
2016

LANGUAGES

- French (*Native*)
English (*Bilingual*)
German (*Basic*)